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(54) **STORAGE CONTAINER FOR GRILLING UTENSILS**

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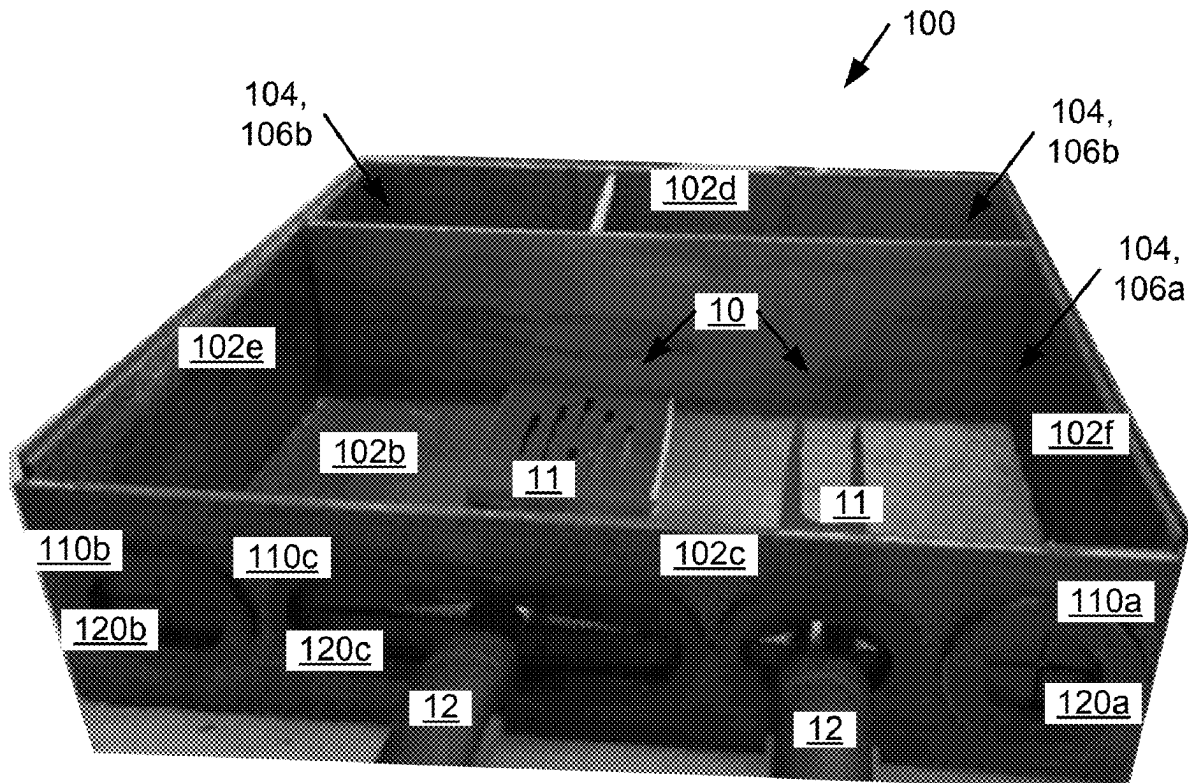
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CPC *A47J 37/0786* (2013.01); *A47J 47/16* (2013.01); *B65D 25/005* (2013.01); *B65D 25/04* (2013.01)

(57)

ABSTRACT

Implementations of a storage container for housing grilling utensils comprise a plurality of surfaces (or sides) configured in the form of a closed box with an open interior and one or more slotted flexible openings therethrough. In some implementations, a method of using the storage container for housing grilling utensils comprises inserting the head of a grilling (or other suitable cooking) utensil through a slotted flexible opening of the storage container for housing grilling utensils into the interior of the storage container for housing grilling utensils.



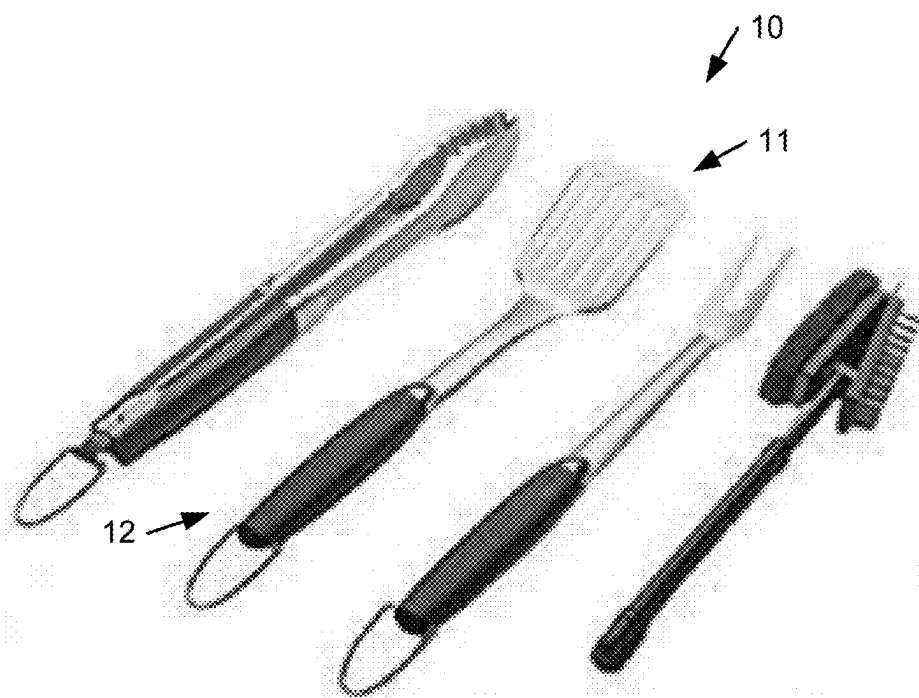


FIG. 1
(PRIOR ART)

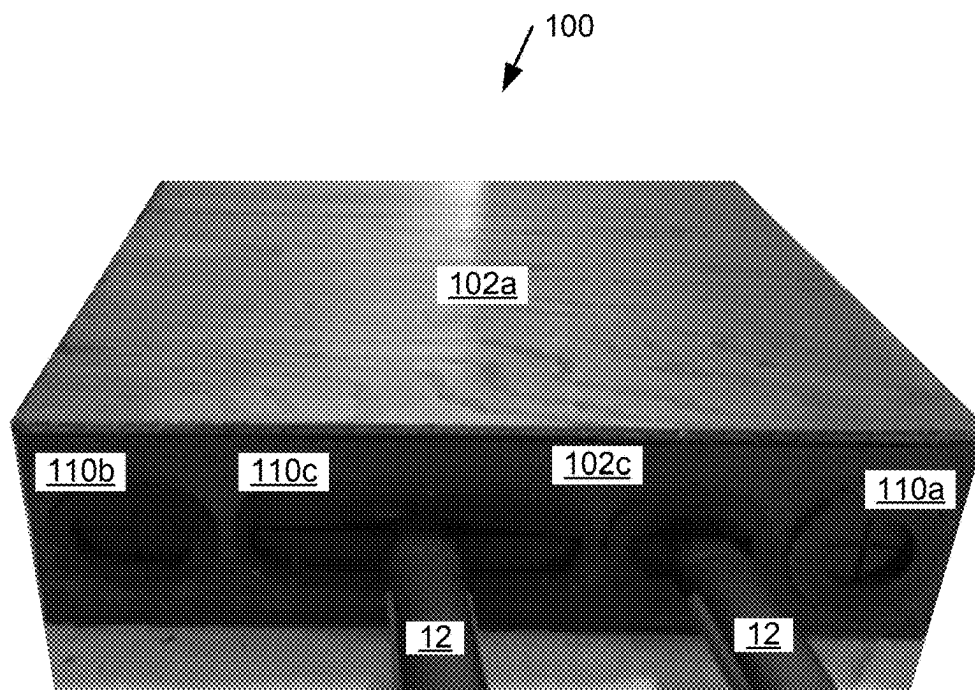


FIG. 2

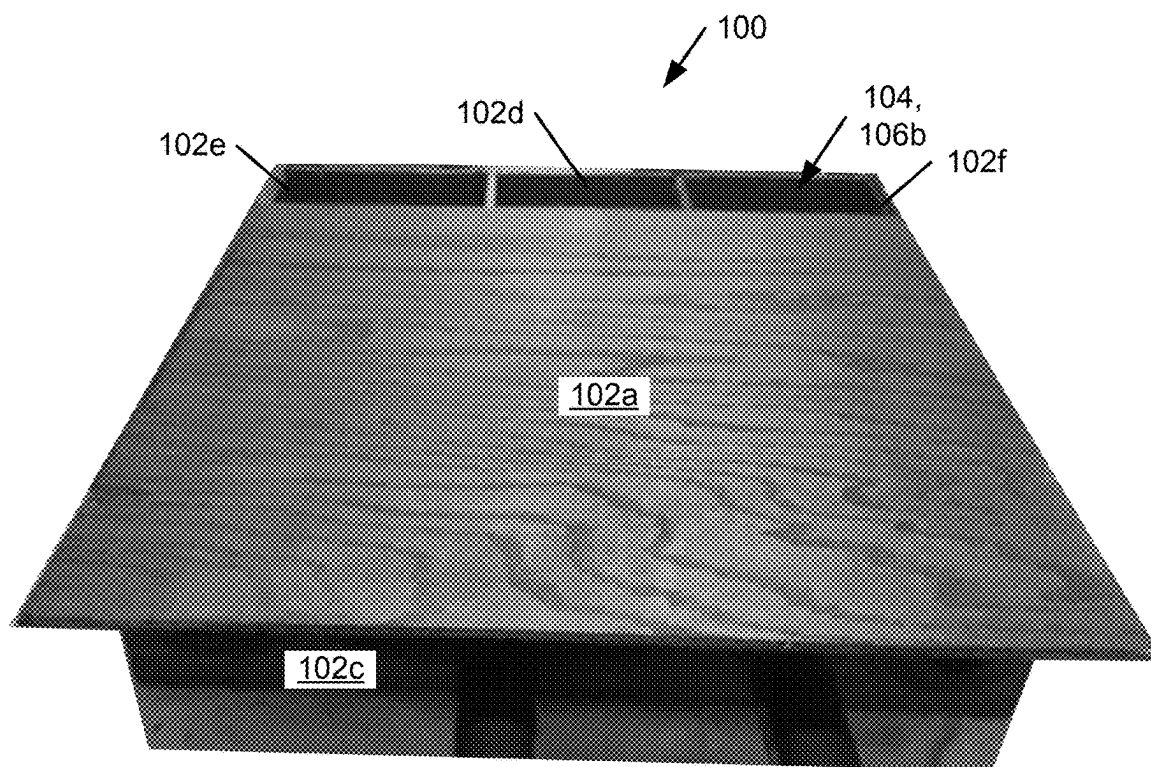


FIG. 3

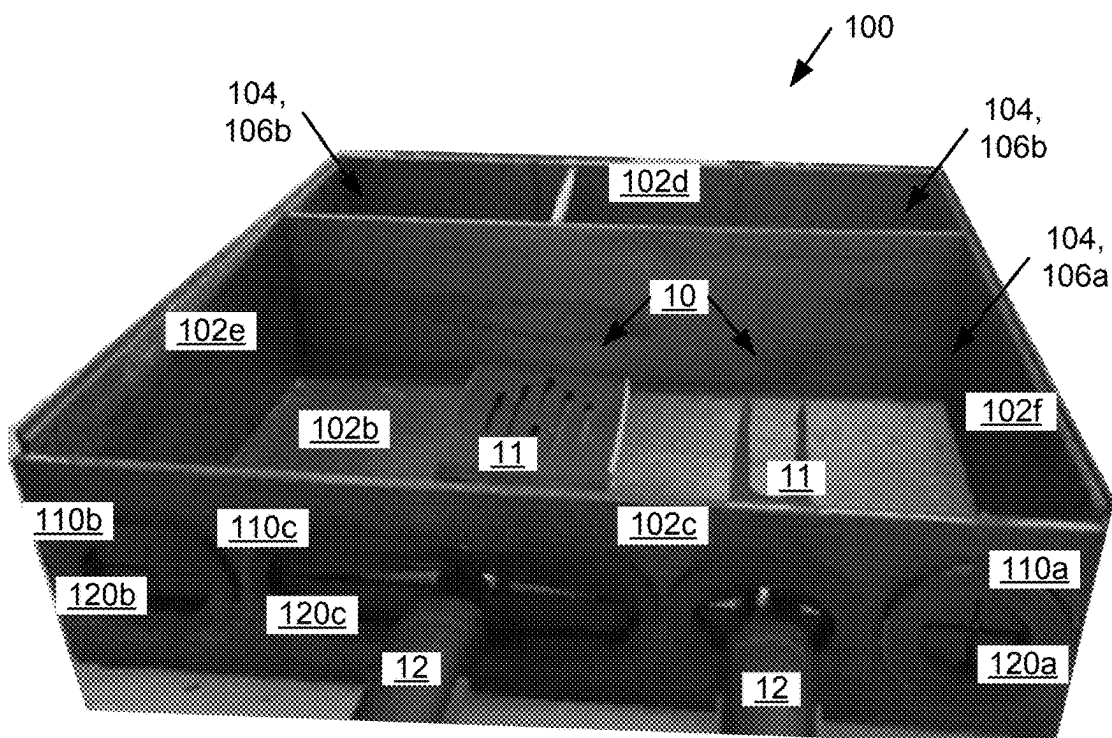


FIG. 4

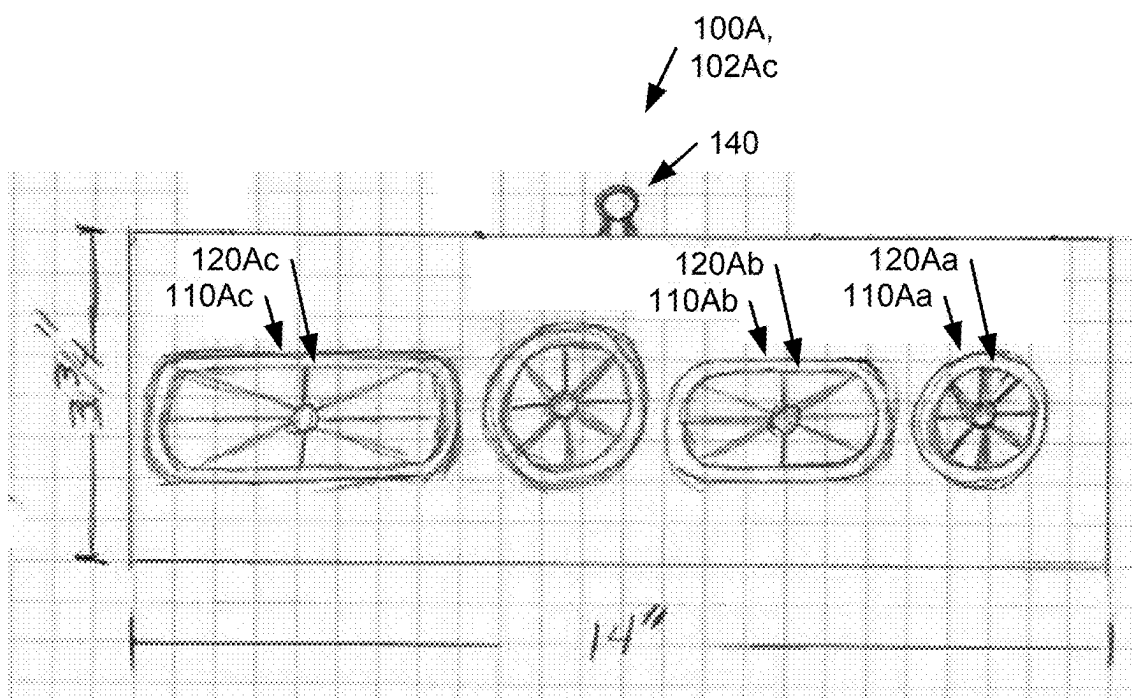


FIG. 5

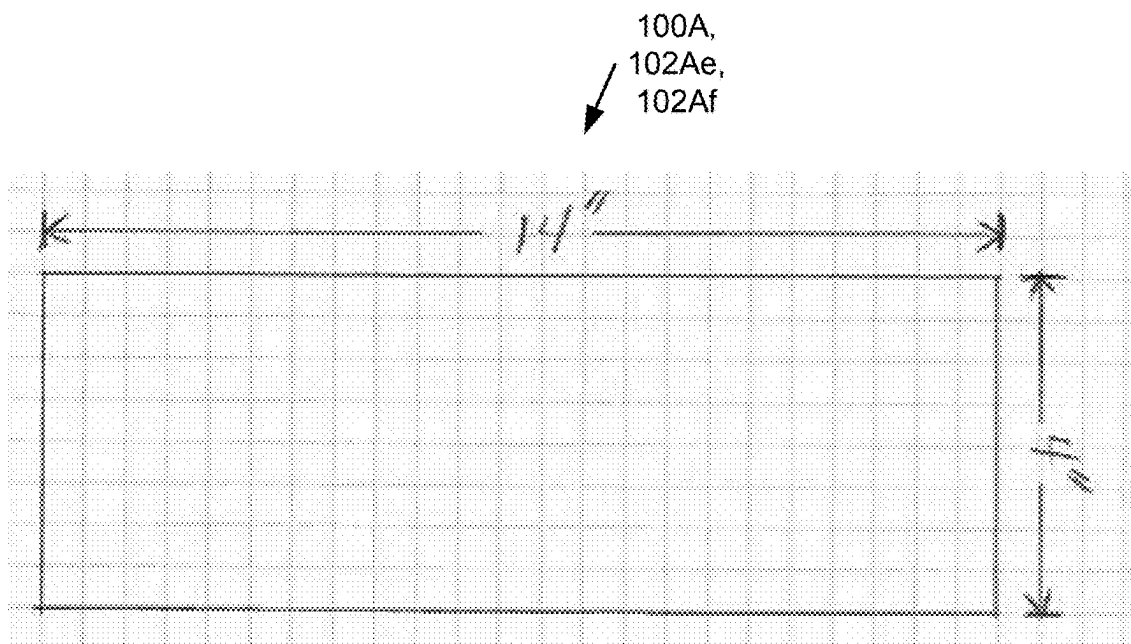


FIG. 6

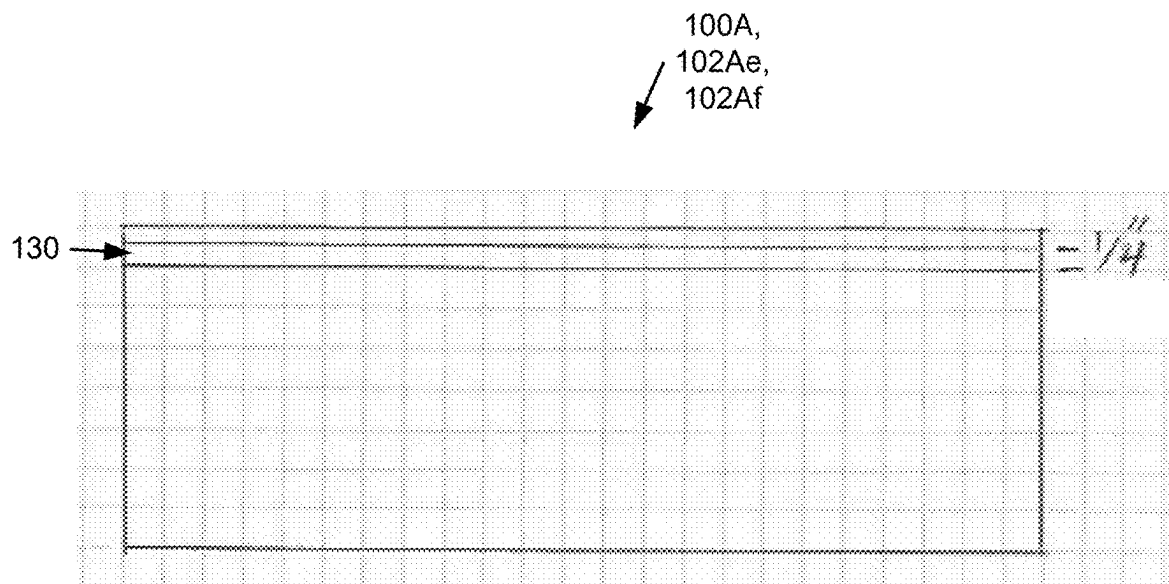


FIG. 7

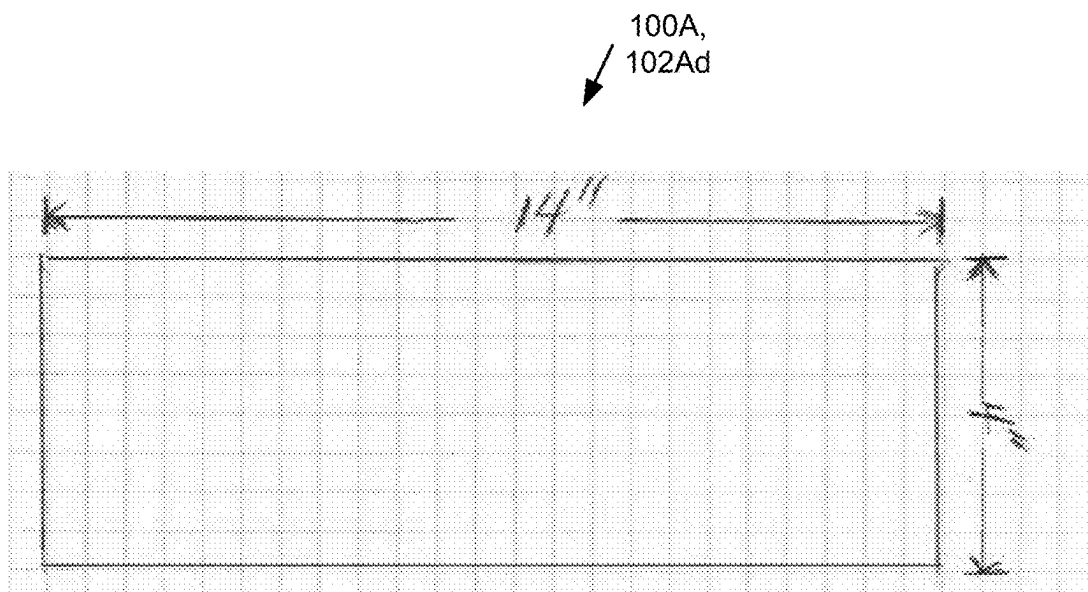


FIG. 8

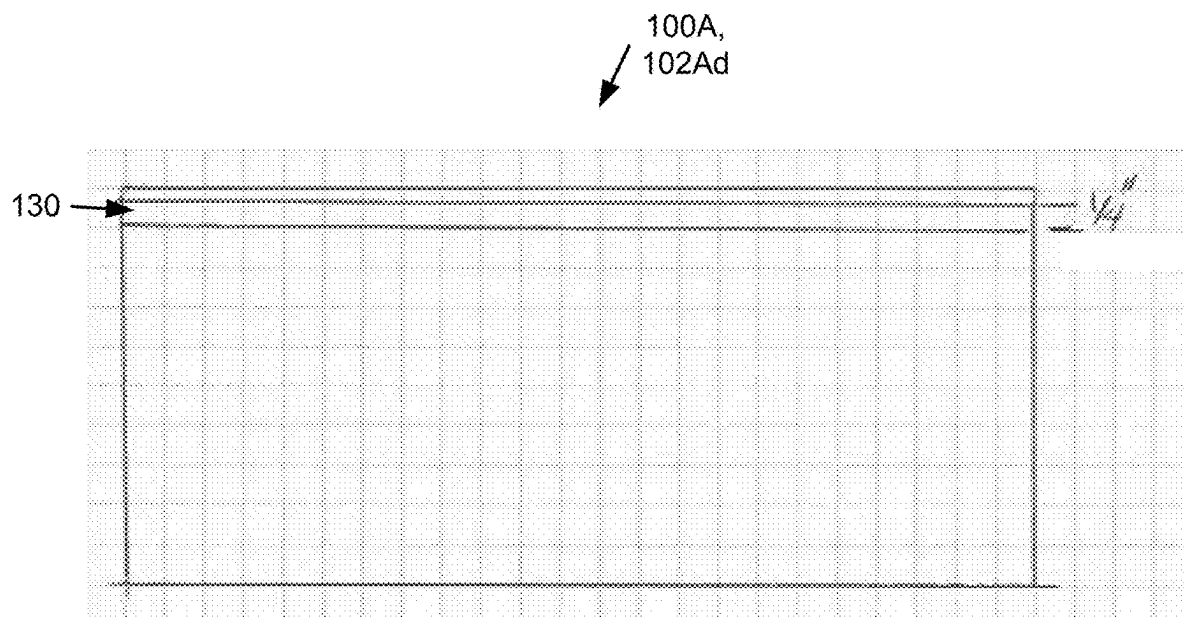


FIG. 9

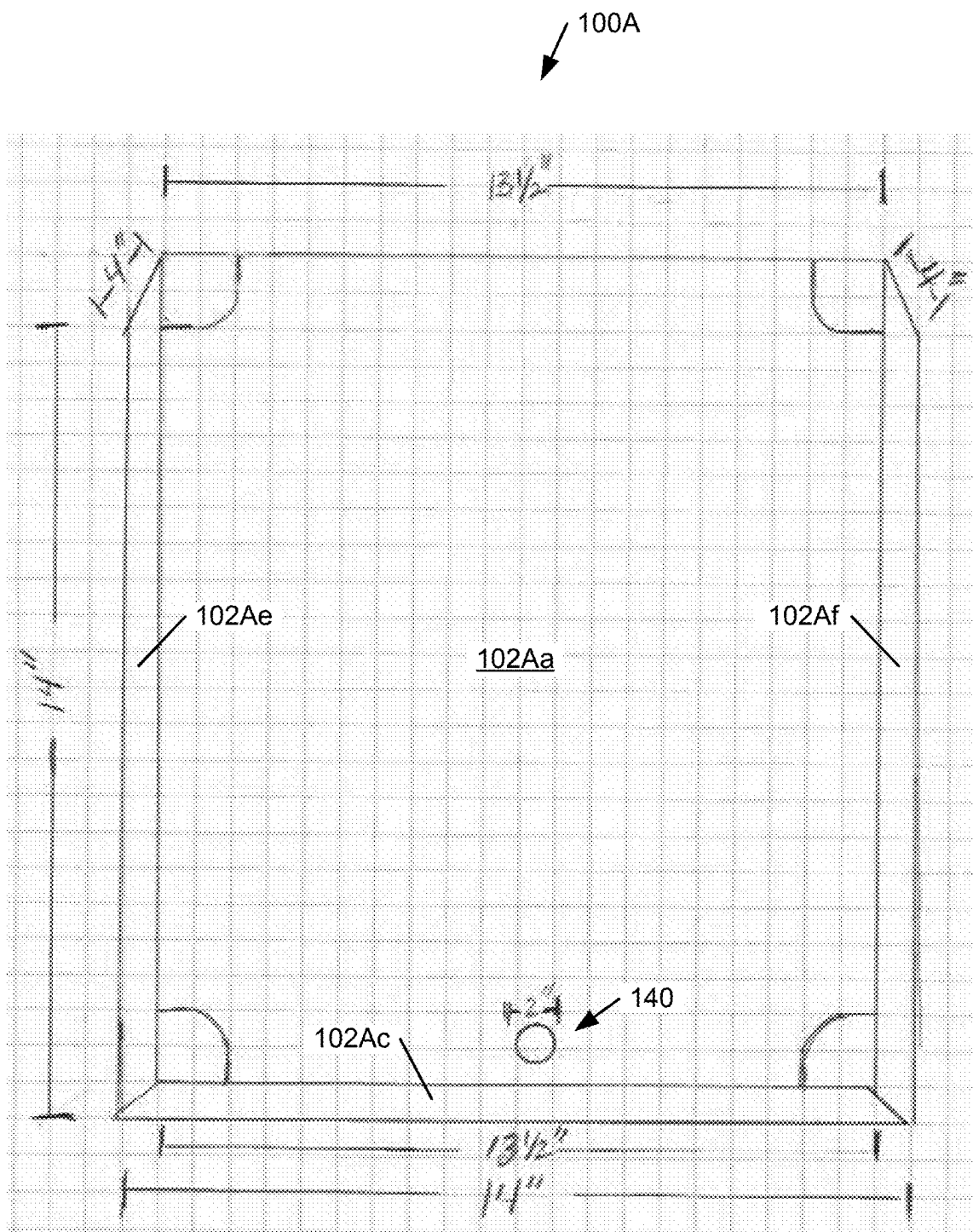


FIG. 10

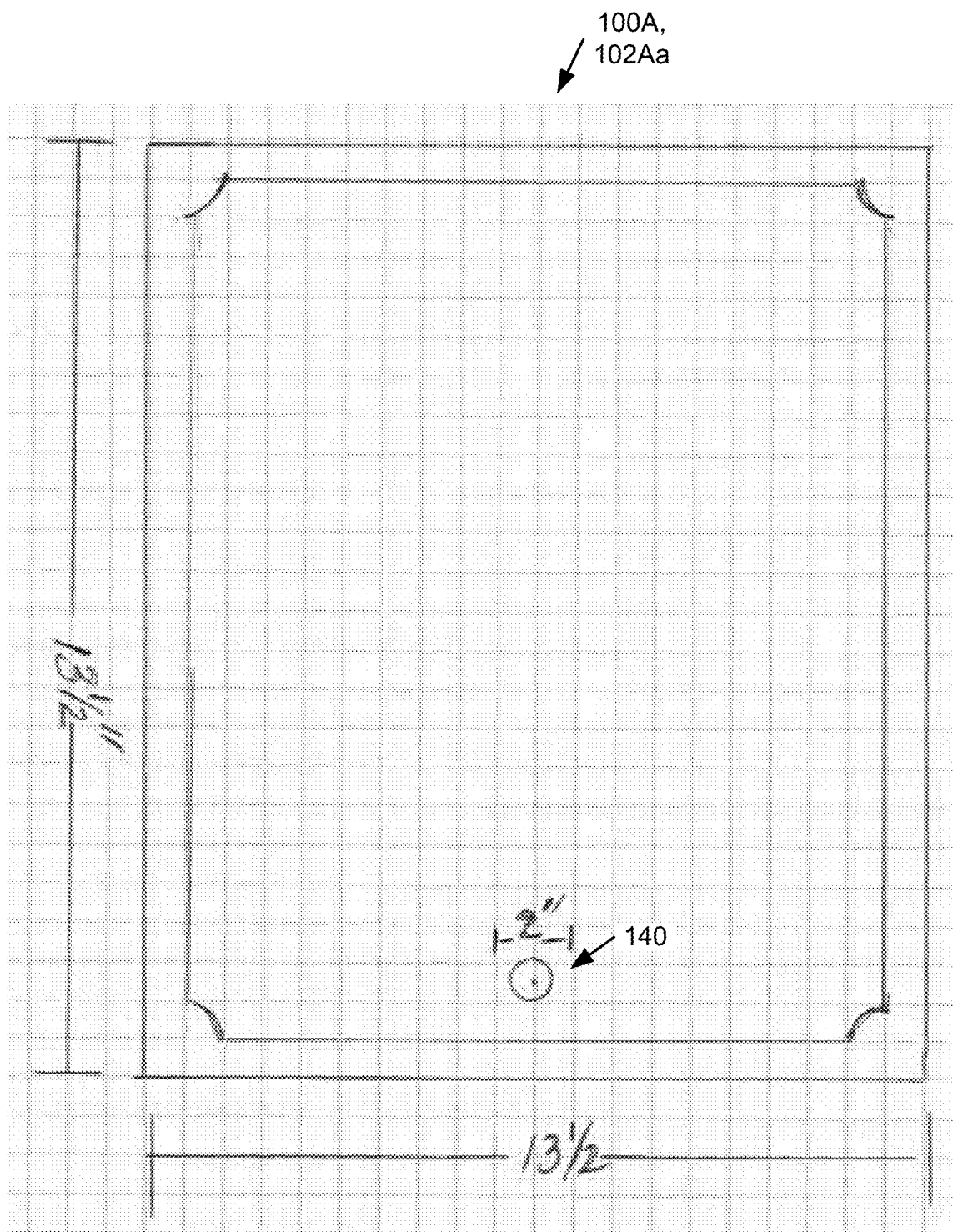


FIG. 11

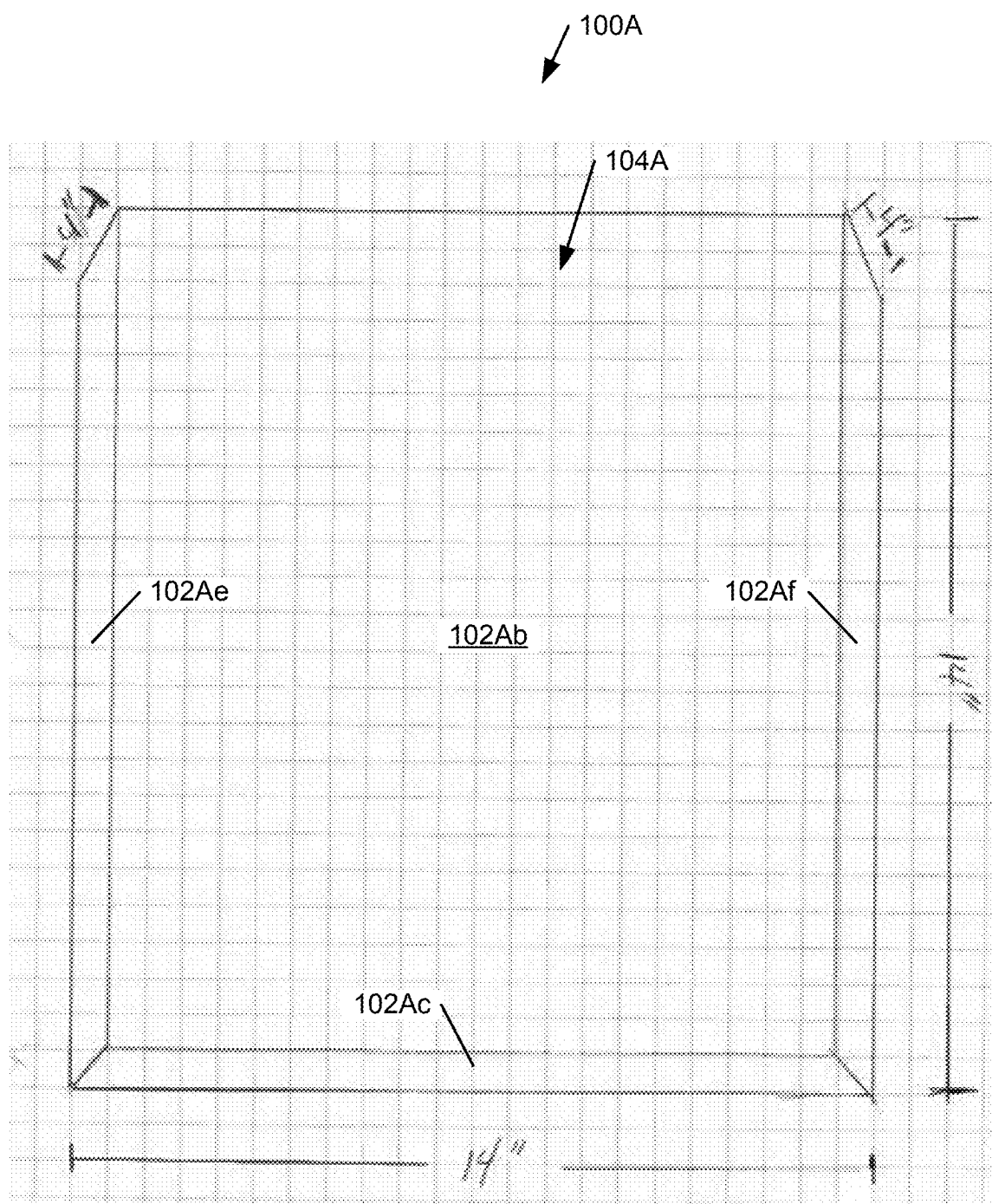


FIG. 12

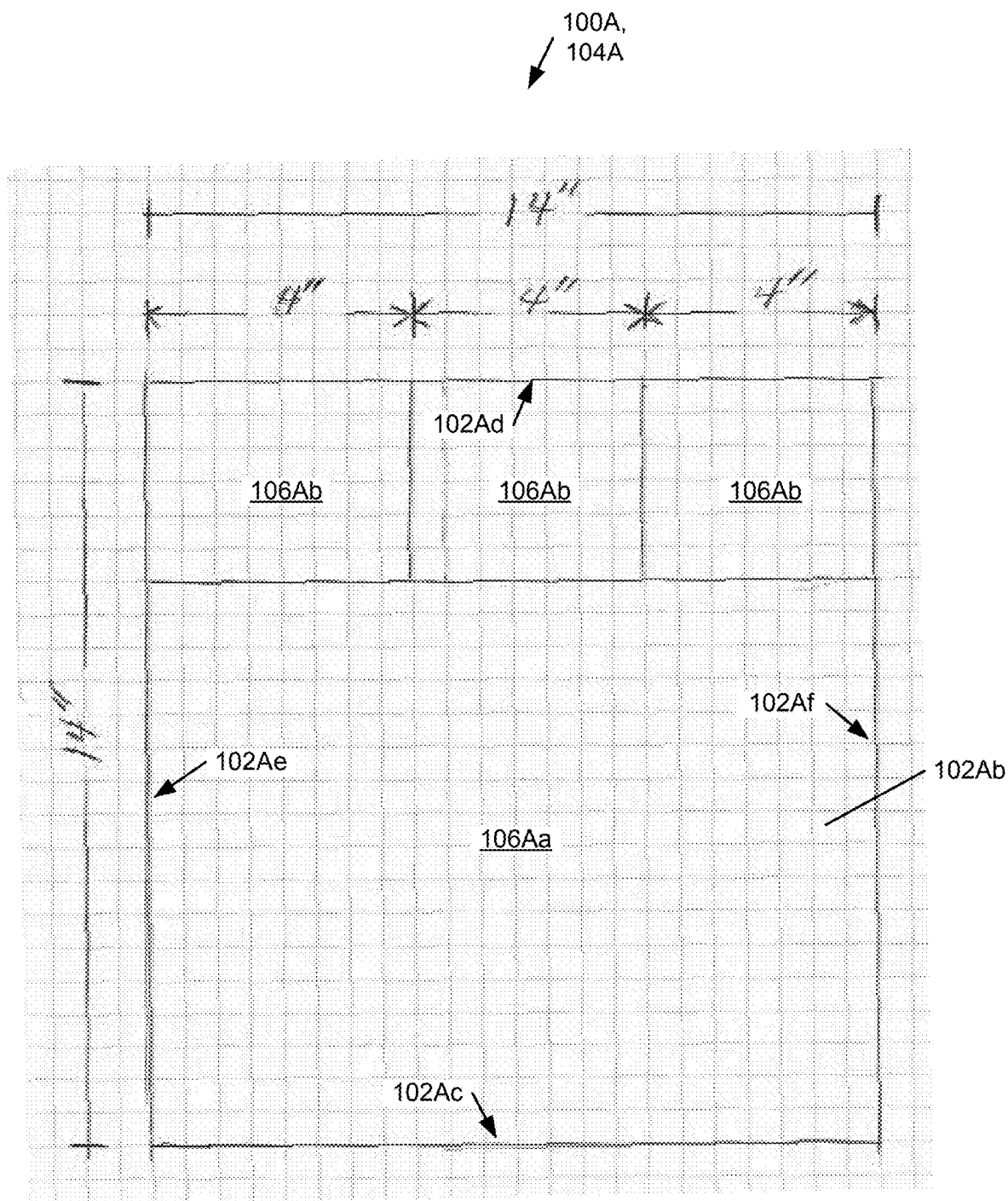


FIG. 13

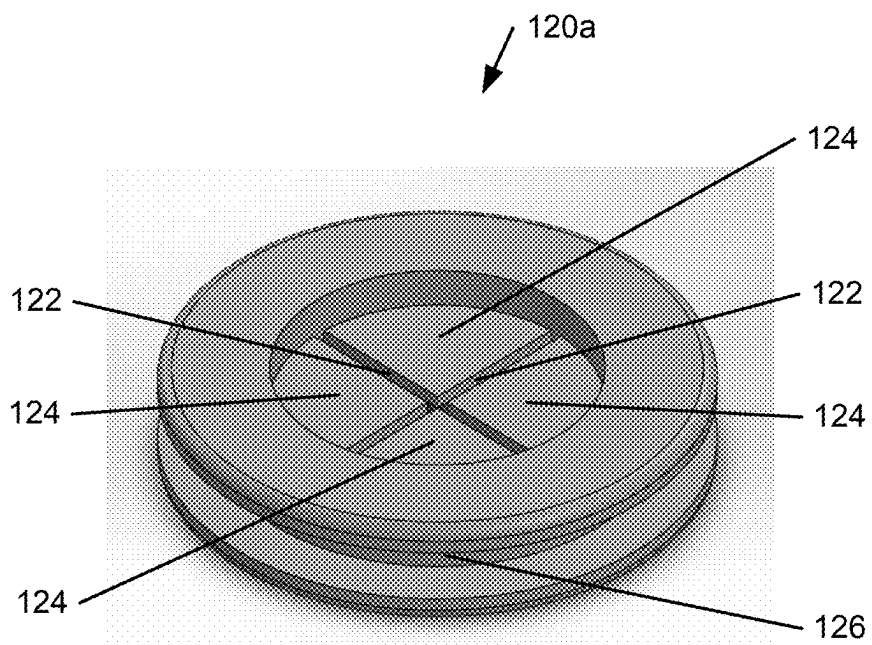


FIG. 14

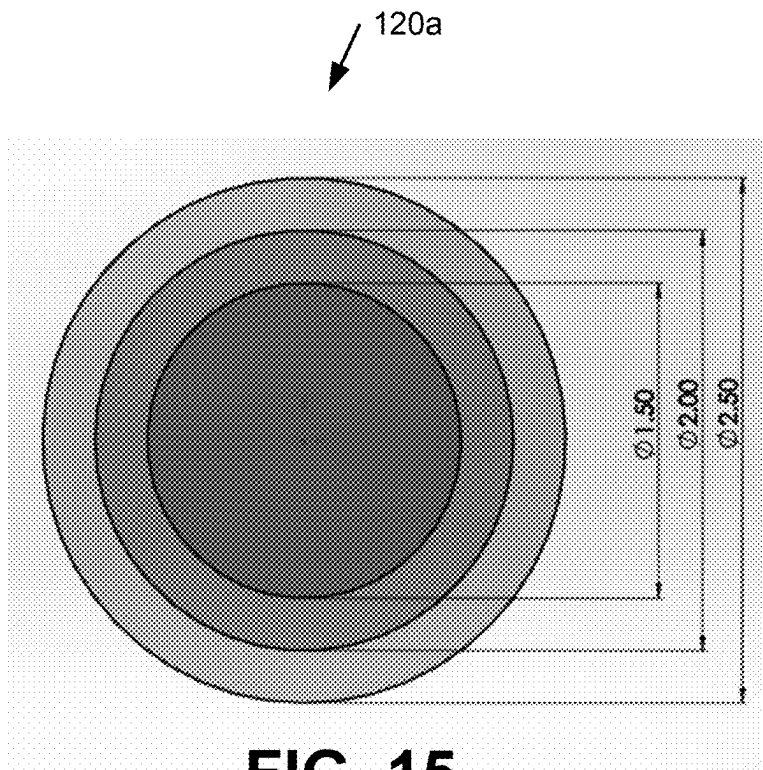


FIG. 15

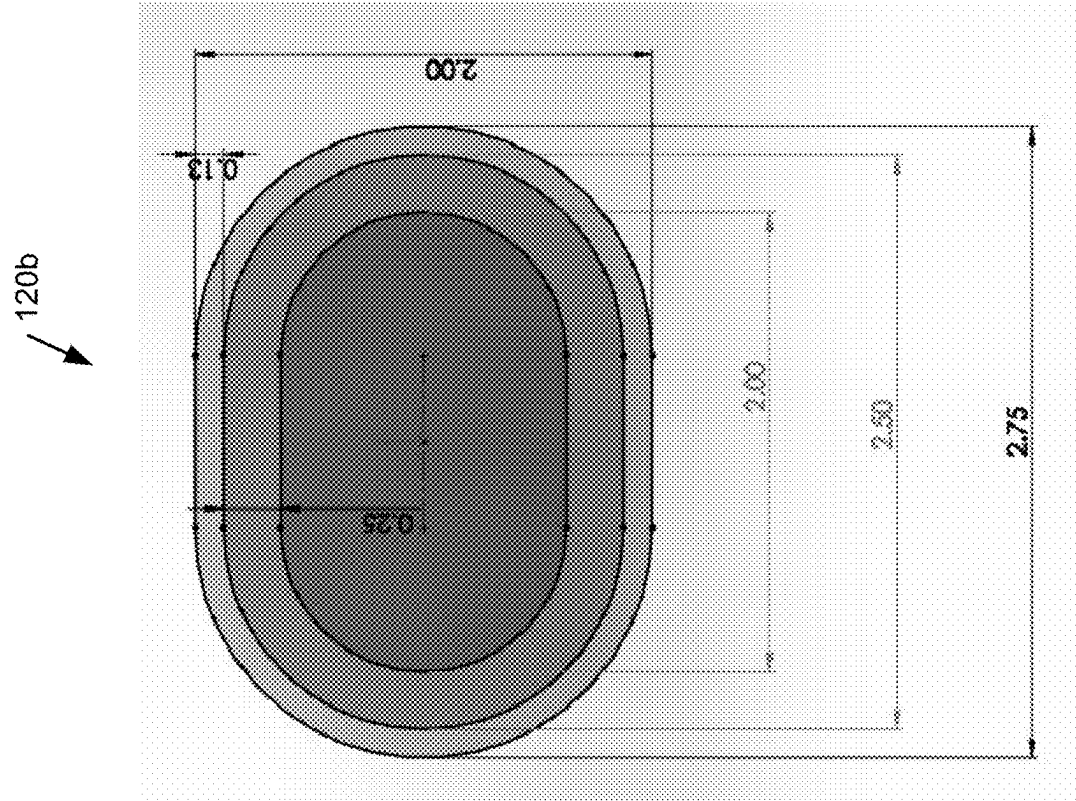


FIG. 17

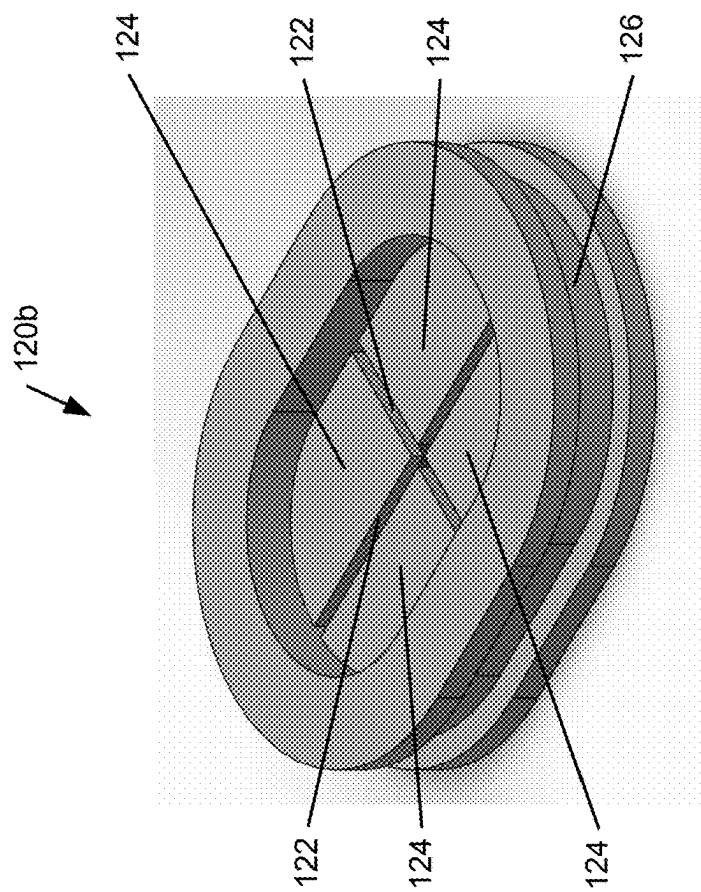


FIG. 16

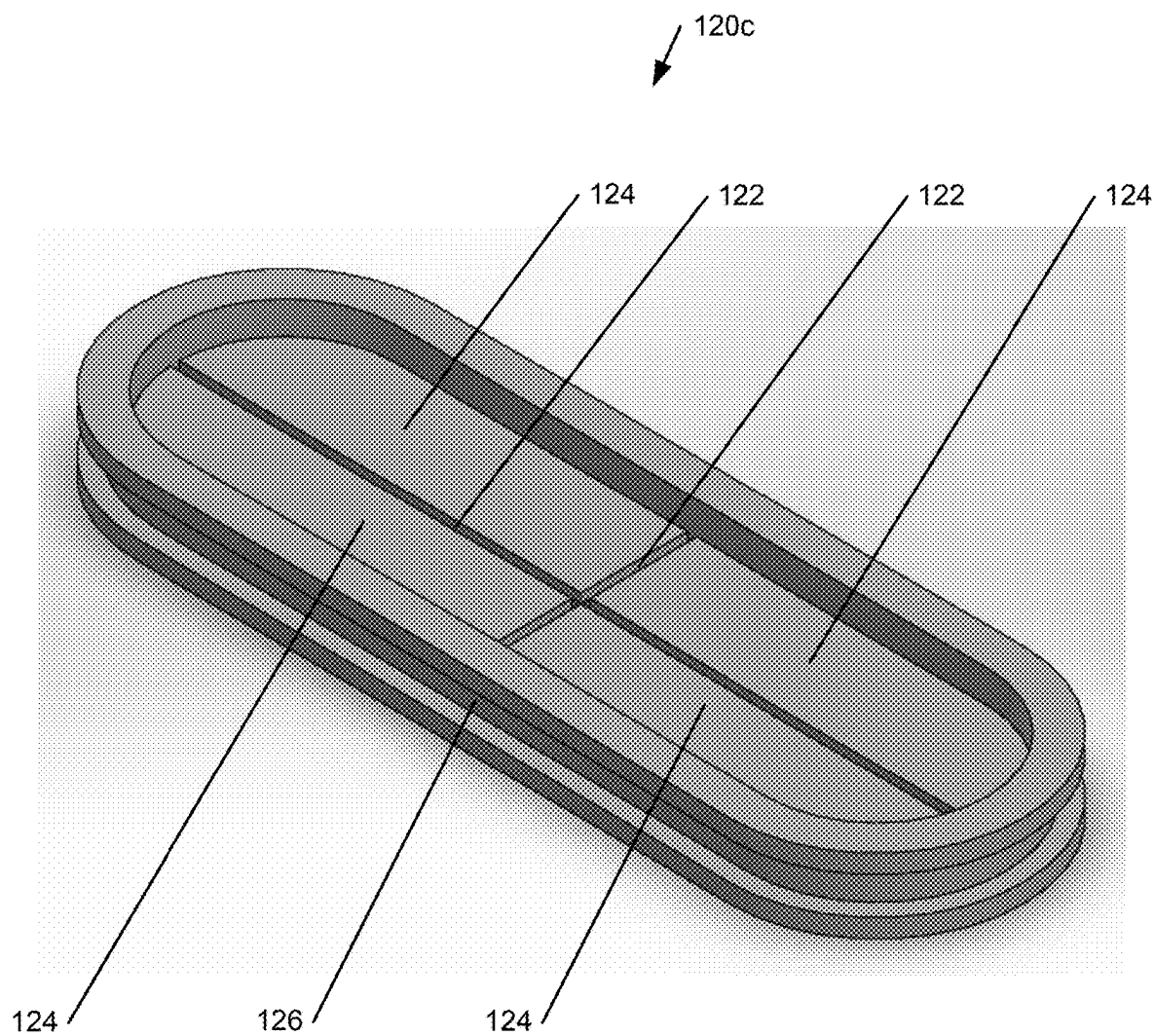


FIG. 18

120c

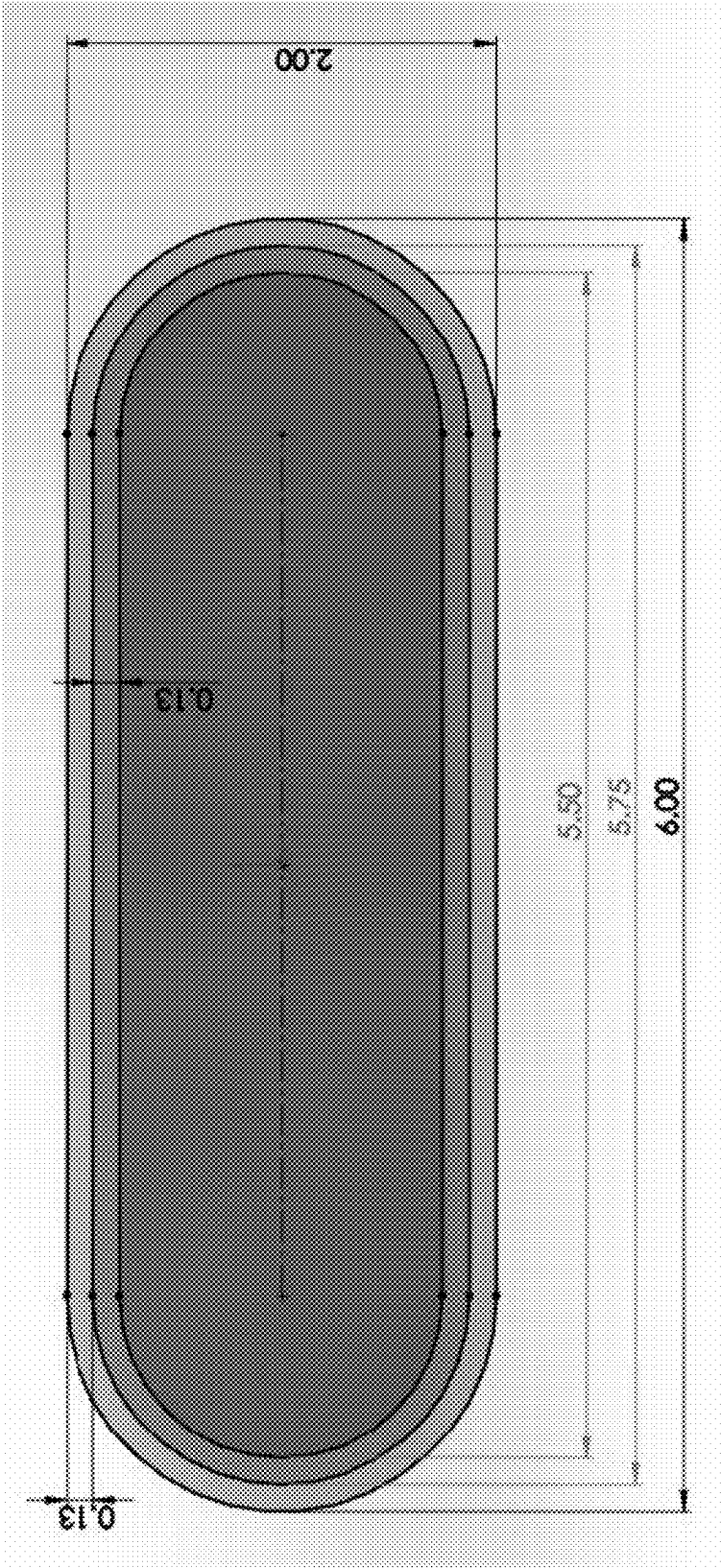


FIG. 19

STORAGE CONTAINER FOR GRILLING UTENSILS

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0001] This disclosure relates to implementations of a storage container for grilling utensils.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Outdoor grilling is a popular pastime. However, flies can make this pastime unsanitary as flies may land on grilling utensils, such as shown in FIG. 1, particularly the head of a grilling utensil that makes contact with food items while the utensil is held by the handle.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0003] FIG. 1 illustrates example existing grilling utensils.

[0004] FIGS. 2-4 illustrate implementations of an example storage container for housing grilling utensils according to the present disclosure.

[0005] FIGS. 5-13 illustrate another implementation of an example storage container for housing grilling utensils according to the present disclosure.

[0006] FIGS. 14-19 illustrate implementations of example flexible material that fills (or covers) the openings of the storage container for housing grilling utensils of FIGS. 2-4 and FIGS. 5-13 according to the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0007] Implementations of a storage container for housing grilling utensils are provided. In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils comprises a plurality of surfaces (or sides) configured in the form of a closed box with an open interior and one or more slotted flexible openings therethrough.

[0008] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils is configured to keep grilling (or any other suitable cooking) utensils safe from flies and sanitary.

[0009] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils is configured to receive the head of a grilling utensil within the interior through a slotted flexible opening of the storage container for housing grilling utensils to protect the utensil from contact by flies or other pests and keep the utensil sanitary.

[0010] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils is configured to provide storage for any other suitable item, such as one or more condiments.

[0011] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils is configured to provide a cutting board or similar surface.

[0012] In some implementations, a method of using the storage container for housing grilling utensils comprises inserting the head of a grilling (or other suitable cooking) utensil through a slotted flexible opening of the storage container for housing grilling utensils into the interior of the storage container for housing grilling utensils. In some implementations, a method of using the storage container for housing grilling utensils may comprise moving and/or removing the top side of the storage container for housing grilling utensils to access the interior of the storage container for housing grilling utensils (such as compartments formed therein) for storage use for condiments or other suitable items.

[0013] In some implementations, a method of using the storage container for housing grilling utensils may comprise removing the top side of the storage container for housing grilling utensils and using the top side as a cutting board or similar surface.

[0014] Outdoor grilling is a popular pastime. However, flies can make this pastime unsanitary as flies may land on grilling utensils 10, such as shown in FIG. 1, particularly the head 11 of a grilling utensil 10 that makes contact with food items while the utensil 10 is held by the handle 12.

[0015] FIGS. 2-4 illustrate implementations of an example storage container for housing grilling utensils 100 according to the present disclosure. As shown in FIGS. 2 and 4, in some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils 100 comprises six surfaces (or sides) 102 configured in the form of a closed box with an open interior 104. For example, in some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils 100 comprises a top 102a, a bottom 102b, and four sides (e.g., front, back, left, and right) 102c, 102d, 102e, 102f.

[0016] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils 100 may comprise any other suitable number of surfaces (or sides) 102 configured in any other suitable closed form with an open interior.

[0017] As shown in FIGS. 2 and 4, in some implementations, one side 102 (e.g., the front side 102c) comprises a plurality of openings 110. For example, in some implementations, the side 102 (102c) may comprise a small (e.g., circular shaped) opening 110a, a medium (e.g., oval or stadium shaped) opening 110b, and/or a large (e.g., elongated oval or stadium shaped) opening 110c.

[0018] In some implementations, the openings 110 may be any other suitable size and/or shape.

[0019] In some implementations, the openings 110 are configured (e.g., sized and/or shaped) to receive the head of a utensil (e.g., a utensil 10 of FIG. 1) to insert or remove the head 11 of the utensil 10 from the interior 104 of the storage container for housing grilling utensils 100.

[0020] As shown in FIG. 4, in some implementations, the openings 110 are filled with or comprise a flexible material (e.g., a flexible insert or grommet) 120. FIGS. 14-19 illustrate implementations of example flexible material 120 that fills (or covers) the openings 110, 110A of the storage container for housing grilling utensils of FIGS. 2-4 and FIGS. 5-13 respectively according to the present disclosure.

[0021] As shown in FIGS. 4, 14, 16, and 18, in some implementations, the flexible material 120 may comprise a small sized (e.g., circular shaped) flexible material 120a, a medium sized (e.g., oval or stadium shaped) flexible material 120b, and/or a large sized (e.g., elongated oval or stadium shaped) flexible material 120c. In some implementations, the flexible material 120 may be any other suitable size and/or shape.

[0022] As shown in FIGS. 14, 16, and 18, in some implementations, the flexible material 120 (i.e., 120a, 120b, 120c) comprises a slit 122 (i.e., 122a, 122b, 122c) for receiving the head of a utensil 10. In some implementations, the flexible material 120 comprises a "t" (e.g., a letter t) or "+" (e.g., a plus sign or plus symbol) shaped slit 122 thereby forming four flaps 124 in the opening 110.

[0023] As shown in FIG. 3, in some implementations, the top surface (or side) 102a of the storage container for

housing grilling utensils **100** is moveable to allow access to the interior **104** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**.

[0024] In some implementations, the top surface **102a** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** is removable. In this way, in some implementations, the top surface **102a** can also be used as a cutting board or for any other suitable use.

[0025] As shown in FIG. 4, in some implementations, the interior **104** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**, opposite the openings **110**, comprises one or more partitions forming one or more sections or compartments **106** (e.g., **106a**, **106b**) in the interior **104**.

[0026] In some implementations, one or more of the compartments **106a** are configured (e.g., sized and/or shaped) to receive the head (or at least the head portion) **11** of one or more utensils **10** inserted into the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** through the openings **110**. In some implementations, one or more of the compartments **106b** are configured to provide storage for any other suitable item, such as one or more condiments.

[0027] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** is configured to keep grilling (or any other suitable cooking) utensils **10** safe from flies and sanitary.

[0028] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** is configured to receive the head **11** of a grilling utensil **10** within the interior **104** through an opening **110** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** to protect the utensil **10** from contact by flies or other pests and keep the utensil **10** sanitary.

[0029] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** is configured (e.g., sized and/or shaped) to receive at least the head portion **11** of a grilling utensil **10** within the interior **104** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** while allowing at least the handle portion **12** of the utensil **10** to extend outside of the interior **104** through an opening **110** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**.

[0030] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** is configured to provide storage for any other suitable item, such as one or more condiments.

[0031] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** is configured to provide a cutting board or similar surface.

[0032] FIGS. 5-13 illustrate another implementation of an example storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A** (collectively referred to below as the “storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**”) according to the present disclosure. FIG. 5 illustrates an exterior view of the front side **102Ac** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**. FIGS. 6 and 7 illustrate exterior and interior views respectively of the left and right sides **102Ae**, **102Af** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**. FIGS. 8 and 9 illustrate exterior and interior views respectively of the back side **102Ad** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**.

[0033] FIG. 10 illustrates an exterior, top view of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**. FIG. 11 illustrates an exterior view of the top side **102Aa** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**. FIG. 12 illustrates a perspective view of the interior **104A** (without compartments **106A**) of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**. FIG. 13 illustrates a top view of the

interior **104A** (with compartments **106A**) of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**.

[0034] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A** is the same or similar to the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** described herein for FIGS. 2-4. For example, as shown in FIGS. 5-10, 12, and 13, in some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A** comprises six surfaces (or sides) **102A** configured in the form of a closed box with an open interior **104A** that are the same or similar respectively to the six surfaces (or sides) **102** configured in the form of a closed box with an open interior **104** of FIGS. 2-4.

[0035] As shown in FIGS. 7 and 9, in some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A** may further comprise a groove **130**. In some implementations, the groove **130** extends along the length of the inner surface of the left side **102Ae**, right side **102Af**, and/or back side **102Ac**. In some implementations, the groove **130** extends along the sides **102Ae**, **102Af**, **102Ac** at or near the upward facing edge of the sides **102Ae**, **102Af**, **102Ac**.

[0036] In some implementations, the groove **130** may extend in any other suitable configuration and/or position.

[0037] In some implementations, the groove **130** is configured to allow the top side **102Aa** to be moved and/or removed from the closed position adjacent to the sides **102Ae**, **102Af**, **102Ac**. For example, in some implementations, the groove **130** is configured to receive a portion (e.g., one or more edges) of the top side **102Aa** such that the top side **102Aa** can be moved and/or removed.

[0038] In some implementations, the top side **102Aa** may be movable and/or removable from the sides **102Ae**, **102Af**, **102Ac** in any other suitable way.

[0039] As shown in FIGS. 5, 10, and 11, in some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A** may further comprise a knob or handle **140**. In some implementations, the knob **140** is attached to the top side **102Aa**.

[0040] In some implementations, the knob **140** may be attached to any other suitable part of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**.

[0041] In some implementations, the knob **140** is configured to assist in moving (or removing) the top side **102Aa** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100A**. In some implementations, the knob **140** is configured to assist in positioning and/or securing the top side **102Aa**, such as for use of the top side **102Aa** as a cutting board or another suitable use.

[0042] As described above, FIGS. 14-19 illustrate implementations of example flexible material (e.g., a flexible insert or grommet) **120** that fills (or covers) the openings **110**, **110A** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils of FIGS. 2-4 and FIGS. 5-13 respectively according to the present disclosure. FIGS. 14 and 15 illustrate views of an example small sized (e.g., circular shaped) flexible material **120a**.

[0043] FIGS. 16 and 17 illustrate views of an example medium sized (e.g., oval or stadium shaped) flexible material **120b**. FIGS. 18 and 19 illustrate views of an example large sized (e.g., elongated oval or stadium shaped) flexible material **120c**.

[0044] As shown in FIGS. 14, 16, and 18, in some implementations, the flexible material **120a**, **120b**, **120c** may

further comprise a groove **126**. In some implementations, the groove **126** extends around the perimeter of the flexible material **120a**, **120b**, **120c**.

[0045] In some implementations, the groove **126** is configured to engage with the edge of the openings **110a**, **110b**, **110c** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** such that the flexible material **120a**, **120b**, **120c** is secured in the opening **110a**, **110b**, **110c** (e.g., similar to a grommet or insert).

[0046] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** comprises any suitable dimensions, such as the dimensions shown in FIGS. **5-13**, **15**, **17**, and **19**.

[0047] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** is composed of any suitable materials. For example, in some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** is composed of wood, plastic, and/or rubber materials.

[0048] In some implementations, the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** can have any suitable appearance, such as the example appearance shown in the above-described figures.

[0049] In some implementations, an example method of using the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**, with respect to the above-described figures, comprises inserting the head of a cooking utensil (e.g., a grilling utensil **10** of FIG. **1**) through an opening **110** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** into the interior **104** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**.

[0050] In some implementations, the utensil **10** is inserted into the interior **104** such that at least the head portion **11** of the utensil is positioned in the interior **104** and at least the handle portion **12** of the utensil **10** extends outside of the interior **104**, such as shown in FIGS. **2** and **4**. In this way, in some implementations, the head **11** of the utensil **10** is protected from contact by flies or other pests and kept sanitary.

[0051] In some implementations, the utensil **10** is inserted by using the handle **12** of the utensil **10**.

[0052] In some implementations, the method further comprises removing the head **11** of the utensil **10** from the interior **104** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**, such as to use the utensil **10**. In some implementations, the utensil **10** is removed by using the handle **12** of the utensil **10**.

[0053] In some implementations, a method of using the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** may comprise moving and/or removing the top side **102a** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** to access the interior **104** (e.g., the compartments **106**) of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**, such as shown in FIGS. **3** and **4**. In this way, in some implementations, other suitable items, such as condiments, can be stored and accessed from the interior **104** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100**.

[0054] In some implementations, a method of using the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** may comprise removing the top side **102a** of the storage container for housing grilling utensils **100** and using the top side **102a** as a cutting board or other suitable use.

[0055] The figures, including photographs and drawings, comprised herewith may represent one or more implementations of the storage container for housing grilling utensils.

[0056] Details shown in the figures, such as dimensions, descriptions, etc., are exemplary, and there may be implementations of other suitable details according to the present disclosure.

[0057] Reference throughout this specification to “an embodiment” or “implementation” or words of similar import means that a particular described feature, structure, or characteristic is comprised in at least one embodiment of the present invention. Thus, the phrase “in some implementations” or a phrase of similar import in various places throughout this specification does not necessarily refer to the same embodiment.

[0058] Many modifications and other embodiments of the inventions set forth herein will come to mind to one skilled in the art to which these inventions pertain having the benefit of the teachings presented in the foregoing descriptions and the associated drawings.

[0059] The described features, structures, or characteristics may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments. In the above description, numerous specific details are provided for a thorough understanding of embodiments of the invention. One skilled in the relevant art will recognize, however, that embodiments of the invention can be practiced without one or more of the specific details, or with other methods, components, materials, etc. In other instances, well-known structures, materials, or operations may not be shown or described in detail.

[0060] While operations may be depicted in the drawings in a particular order, this should not be understood as requiring that such operations be performed in the particular order shown or in sequential order, or that all illustrated operations be performed, to achieve desirable results.

1. A storage container for grilling utensils comprising:
 - a bottom and a plurality of sides defining an open interior to form an open top container and a lid configured to form a closed container when placed on top of the open top container wherein:

- the sides comprise a right side, left side, a front side, a back side;

- the front side comprises a plurality of openings wherein each opening extends through the front side and comprises a flexible slotted material mounted inside the opening and wherein each opening is sized and shaped to receive a grilling utensil head through the opening and into the open interior such that the heads of the grilling utensils extend through the openings and into the open interior; and

- the open interior comprises one or more partitions forming at least two compartments wherein a first compartment is sized to receive the grilling utensil heads received through the plurality of openings and a second compartment located behind the first compartment and adjacent to the back side.

2. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim **1** comprising inserting a grilling utensil head horizontally into the open interior through a slotted flexible opening such that the grilling utensil head extends through the opening and into the open interior.

3. The storage container of claim **1** further comprising a handle extending from the lid.

4. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim **1** comprising using the lid as a cutting board.

5. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim 3 comprising moving the lid using the handle.

6. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim 2 comprising removing the lid from the storage container and using the lid as a cutting board.

7. The storage container of claim 1 wherein the plurality of openings comprise at least two different sizes.

8. A method of using the storage container of claim 1 comprising:

inserting a grilling utensil head horizontally into the open interior through the slotted flexible opening such that the grilling utensil extends horizontally through the opening and the open interior in the first compartment; and

moving the lid of the storage container to access the open interior; and

storing condiments in the second compartment separate from the first compartment.

9. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim 1 comprising:

inserting a grilling utensil head horizontally into the open interior through the slotted flexible opening such that the grilling utensil extends horizontally through the opening and the open interior; and
using the lid as a cutting board.

10. A storage container for grilling utensils comprising: a plurality of sides defining an open interior, wherein the sides comprise:

- a top side;
- a bottom side;
- a front side
- a back side;
- a left side; and
- a right side;

wherein the top side is removeable; and

wherein the front side comprises a plurality of openings wherein each opening extends through the front side and comprises a flexible slotted material mounted inside the opening and wherein each opening is sized and shaped to receive a grilling utensil head through the opening and into the open interior such that the heads of the grilling utensils extend through the openings and into the open interior.

11. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim 10 comprising inserting a plurality of grilling utensil heads into the open interior through the

plurality of openings such that the heads of the grilling utensils extend through the openings and into the open interior.

12. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim 10 comprising using the top side as a cutting board.

13. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim 10 comprising moving the top side using the handle.

14. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim 2 comprising removing the top side from the storage container and using the top side as a cutting board.

15. A method of using the storage container of claim 10 comprising:

inserting a plurality of grilling utensil heads horizontally into the open interior through the plurality of openings such that the grilling utensils extend horizontally through the openings and the open interior in a first compartment; and

moving the top side of the storage containing to access the open interior; and

storing condiments in a second compartment separate from the first compartment.

16. A method of using the storage container for grilling utensils of claim 10 comprising:

inserting a plurality of grilling utensil heads horizontally into the open interior through the plurality of openings such that the grilling utensils extend horizontally through the openings and the open interior; and
using the top side as a cutting board.

17. A storage container for grilling utensils comprising: a plurality of sides defining an open interior, wherein the sides comprise:

- a top side;
- a bottom side;
- a front side;
- a back side;
- a left side; and
- a right side;

wherein the front side comprises a plurality of opening each sized and shaped to receive a grilling utensil head through the opening and into the open interior such that the heads of grilling utensils extend through the openings and into the open interior.

* * * * *